

MBA Marketing Management – Week 7: Conducting Marketing Research – 2

(Exam-Ready Summary Notes)

WEEK 7 OVERVIEW

This unit focuses on how organizations evaluate the effectiveness of their marketing efforts through **marketing productivity measurement, marketing metrics, marketing mix modeling, and marketing dashboards**, while also exploring **contemporary marketing research themes** that shape modern marketing practices.

Topics Covered

1. Contemporary Research Themes in Marketing
 2. Measuring Marketing Productivity
 3. Marketing Metrics
 4. Marketing Mix Modelling (MMM)
 5. Marketing Dashboards
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7.1 CONTEMPORARY RESEARCH THEMES IN MARKETING

Introduction

Marketing continuously evolves due to:

- Changing consumer behavior
- Technological advancements
- Globalization
- Digital transformation
- Sustainability concerns

Contemporary research themes help marketers stay relevant and competitive.

Key Contemporary Research Themes

1. Digital Marketing & E-Commerce

Focus: Online marketing strategies and digital business models.

Sub-topics:

- Influencer marketing
- Social media marketing
- SEO
- Content marketing
- Mobile marketing
- Omnichannel marketing

Importance:

Helps businesses reach customers effectively through digital platforms.

2. Consumer Behavior & Psychology

Focus: Understanding why consumers buy.

Sub-topics:

- Behavioral economics
- Neuromarketing
- Consumer neuroscience
- Emotional branding

Importance:

Provides insights into customer decision-making.

3. Sustainability & Ethical Marketing

Focus: Environmentally and socially responsible marketing.

Sub-topics:

- Green marketing
- CSR (Corporate Social Responsibility)
- Sustainable consumption

Importance:

Builds trust and long-term brand value.

4. Big Data Analytics & AI

Focus: Data-driven marketing decisions.

Sub-topics:

- Predictive analytics
- Machine learning
- AI-powered personalization
- Customer insights

Importance:

Improves marketing efficiency and customer targeting.

5. Global Marketing & Cross-Cultural Studies

Focus: Marketing across international markets.

Sub-topics:

- International marketing
- Global branding
- Cultural influences

Importance:

Supports successful global expansion.

6. Customer Experience & Relationship Management

Focus: Long-term customer relationships.

Sub-topics:

- CRM
- Customer journey mapping
- Customer-centric marketing

Importance:

Enhances loyalty and retention.

7. Innovation & New Product Development

Focus: Creating and launching successful products.

Sub-topics:

- NPD methodologies

- Product lifecycle management
 - Disruptive innovation
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8. Marketing in the Sharing Economy

Focus: Collaborative consumption models.

Examples:

- Uber
- Airbnb
- Ola

Importance:

Understanding consumer behavior in shared-access markets.

✅ Importance of Contemporary Research Themes

Importance	Explanation
Relevance	Addresses current market realities
Practical Application	Useful for business decisions
Knowledge Development	Advances marketing theory
Competitive Advantage	Helps firms stay ahead

7.2 MEASURING MARKETING PRODUCTIVITY

✅ Meaning

Marketing Productivity

The measurement of the:

- Effectiveness
- Efficiency

of marketing efforts in generating business outcomes such as:

- Sales
- Revenue

- Brand awareness
 - Customer engagement
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✓ Key Metrics for Measuring Marketing Productivity

1. Return on Investment (ROI)

Measures profitability of marketing campaigns.

Formula

$$ROI = \frac{\text{Net Profit from Marketing Campaign}}{\text{Marketing Cost}} \times 100$$

Example

Marketing Cost = ₹50,000

Net Profit = ₹1,00,000

$$ROI = \frac{100000}{50000} \times 100 = 200\%$$

2. Customer Acquisition Cost (CAC)

Measures cost of acquiring one customer.

Formula

$$CAC = \frac{\text{Total Marketing Spend}}{\text{Number of New Customers}}$$

3. Customer Lifetime Value (CLV)

Predicts total revenue from a customer.

Formula

$$CLV = (\text{Average Purchase Value} \times \text{Purchase Frequency}) \times \text{Customer Lifespan}$$

4. Marketing Qualified Lead (MQL) Conversion Rate

Measures conversion efficiency.

Formula

Formula

$$MQL\ Conversion\ Rate = \frac{Converted\ MQLs}{Total\ MQLs} \times 100$$

5. Brand Awareness & Recognition

Measured through:

- Surveys
 - Website traffic
 - Social media mentions
 - Brand recall studies
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✅ Importance of Measuring Marketing Productivity

1. Resource Allocation

Identify high-performing channels.

2. Performance Evaluation

Assess campaign effectiveness.

3. Better Decision-Making

Supports data-driven strategies.

4. Demonstrating Value

Shows marketing's contribution to business goals.

✅ Challenges

- Attribution issues
- Data integration problems
- Measuring intangible outcomes

- Dynamic market conditions
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7.3 MARKETING METRICS

✓ Meaning

Marketing Metrics are:

Quantifiable measures used to evaluate marketing performance.

✓ Categories of Marketing Metrics

A. Financial Metrics

Examples:

- ROI
 - CAC
 - CLV
 - Revenue Contribution
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B. Customer Engagement Metrics

Examples:

- Click Through Rate (CTR)
 - Conversion Rate
 - Customer Retention Rate
 - Net Promoter Score (NPS)
-

C. Brand Metrics

Examples:

- Brand Awareness
 - Brand Recall
 - Brand Perception
 - Share of Voice (SOV)
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D. Digital Marketing Metrics

Examples:

- Website Traffic
 - CPC (Cost Per Click)
 - CPA (Cost Per Acquisition)
 - Email Open Rate
 - Social Media Engagement
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E. Product Performance Metrics

Examples:

- Sales Volume
 - Market Share
 - Product Adoption Rate
 - Churn Rate
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Importance of Marketing Metrics

- Performance evaluation
 - Strategy optimization
 - Decision support
 - Accountability
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Selecting Appropriate Metrics

Metrics should be:

- ✓ Aligned with objectives
- ✓ Relevant
- ✓ Actionable
- ✓ Measurable
- ✓ Consistent

✓ Challenges

- Data accuracy
- Attribution complexity
- Measuring intangible outcomes
- Real-time monitoring

7.4 MARKETING MIX MODELLING (MMM)

✓ Meaning

Marketing Mix Modelling (MMM) is:

A statistical technique used to measure the impact of different marketing activities on business performance.

✓ Key Aspects

1. Elements Considered

- Pricing
- Advertising
- Promotions
- Distribution

2. Historical Data Usage

Uses past performance data.

3. Statistical Analysis

Uses:

- Regression Analysis
- Predictive Models

4. Insight Generation

Identifies which marketing activities contribute most to sales.

 Components Evaluated

Component	Purpose
Advertising Spend	Impact on sales
Pricing	Effect on demand
Distribution	Reach & availability
Promotions	Sales boost

 Importance of MMM

1. Optimize Marketing Spend

Invest more in high-performing activities.

2. Evaluate ROI

Measure campaign effectiveness.

3. Data-Driven Decisions

Reduce guesswork.

4. Forecasting

Predict future outcomes.

 Implementation Steps

- 1. Data Collection
 - 2. Data Cleaning
 - 3. Model Development
 - 4. Statistical Analysis
 - 5. Interpretation
 - 6. Strategic Application
-

✓ Challenges

- Poor data quality
 - Attribution issues
 - Dynamic markets
 - Complex interpretation
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7.5 MARKETING DASHBOARDS

✓ Meaning

Marketing Dashboards are:

Interactive visual tools displaying marketing KPIs and performance indicators in one place.

✓ Key Features

1. Data Visualization

Uses:

- Graphs
 - Charts
 - Visual reports
-

2. Real-Time Monitoring

Provides updated performance information.

3. Customization

Can be tailored to user needs.

4. Data Integration

Combines information from multiple platforms.

✓ Components of Marketing Dashboards

KPI Monitoring

Examples:

- Website Traffic
 - CTR
 - Conversion Rate
 - CAC
-

Campaign Performance

Tracks campaign results.

Social Media Analytics

Measures:

- Reach
 - Engagement
 - Followers
 - Impressions
-

Sales & Revenue Metrics

Displays:

- Revenue
 - Sales Growth
 - ROI
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Importance

1. Quick Data Access

Real-time visibility.

2. Performance Evaluation

Continuous monitoring.

3. Strategic Alignment

Tracks progress against objectives.

4. Better Communication

Simplifies complex data.

Implementation Steps

1. Define objectives
2. Collect data
3. Select dashboard tools
4. Configure KPIs
5. Enable real-time updates

Challenges

- Data consistency
- Information overload
- Integration issues
- User training

QUICK COMPARISON TABLE

Topic	Purpose
Marketing Productivity	Measure effectiveness
Marketing Metrics	Track performance
Mix Modelling	Analyze marketing impact
Dashboard	Visualize performance
Marketing Insights	Support decisions

EXPECTED EXAM QUESTIONS WITH ANSWERS

Q1. Explain Contemporary Research Themes in Marketing. (10 Marks)

Answer:

Contemporary research themes include:

1. Digital Marketing & E-commerce
2. Consumer Behavior & Psychology
3. Sustainability & Ethical Marketing
4. Big Data Analytics & AI
5. Global Marketing
6. CRM & Customer Experience
7. Innovation & NPD
8. Sharing Economy

These themes help organizations remain competitive and responsive to market changes.

Q2. What is Marketing Productivity? Explain its Metrics. (10 Marks)**Answer:**

Marketing productivity measures the effectiveness and efficiency of marketing efforts.

Key metrics:

- ROI
- CAC
- CLV
- MQL Conversion Rate
- Brand Awareness

These metrics help evaluate performance and optimize resource allocation.

Q3. Explain Marketing Metrics and their Importance. (10 Marks)**Answer:**

Marketing metrics are quantifiable measures used to evaluate marketing performance.

Categories:

- Financial
- Customer Engagement
- Brand

- Digital Marketing
- Product Performance

Importance:

- Performance evaluation
 - Decision-making
 - Accountability
 - Strategy improvement
-

Q4. Explain Marketing Mix Modelling (MMM). (10 Marks)

Answer:

MMM is a statistical technique that evaluates the impact of advertising, pricing, distribution, and promotions on business performance using historical data and regression analysis.

Benefits:

- ROI measurement
 - Budget optimization
 - Forecasting
 - Strategic decision-making
-

Q5. What are Marketing Dashboards? Explain their Components. (10 Marks)

Answer:

Marketing dashboards are visual tools displaying marketing KPIs.

Components:

- KPI monitoring
- Campaign performance
- Social media analytics
- Sales and revenue metrics

Benefits:

- Real-time monitoring
- Better decisions
- Strategic alignment

CASE STUDY-BASED ANSWERS (MARKETING MANAGEMENT)

Case 1: Digital Campaign Generating Traffic but Low Sales

Problem

High website visits but poor conversion.

Analysis

- Low conversion rate
- Weak CTA
- Poor user experience

Solution

- Track CTR and Conversion Rate
- Improve landing pages
- Optimize customer journey
- Use dashboard monitoring

Case 2: Rising Marketing Costs but No Revenue Growth

Problem

Marketing spend increasing without proportional sales.

Analysis

- Poor ROI
- Ineffective channel allocation

Solution

- Calculate ROI, CAC, and CLV
- Conduct Mix Modelling
- Redirect budget to high-performing channels

Case 3: New Product Launch Fails

Problem

Product receives poor market response.

Analysis

- Weak customer insights
- Poor market research

Solution

- Use contemporary research techniques
 - Conduct customer behavior analysis
 - Improve NPD process
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Case 4: Company Wants Better Marketing Decisions

Problem

Decisions based on intuition.

Solution

- Implement marketing dashboards
 - Use marketing metrics
 - Track KPIs regularly
 - Apply data-driven decision-making
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Case 5: Multi-Channel Marketing Attribution Problem

Problem

Company cannot identify which channel generates sales.

Solution

- Apply Marketing Mix Modelling
 - Integrate channel data
 - Measure contribution of each marketing activity
 - Optimize spending accordingly
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FINAL EXAM REVISION SHEET

Contemporary Themes

→ Digital Marketing, AI, Sustainability, CRM, Global Marketing

Marketing Productivity Metrics

→ ROI, CAC, CLV, MQL Conversion Rate

Marketing Metrics Categories

→ Financial, Customer, Brand, Digital, Product

Mix Modelling

→ Statistical analysis of marketing activities

Marketing Dashboard

→ Real-time visualization of KPIs

Most Important Formulas

ROI

$$ROI = \frac{Net\ Profit}{Marketing\ Cost} \times 100$$

CAC

$$CAC = \frac{Marketing\ Spend}{New\ Customers}$$

CLV

$$CLV = (Average\ Purchase\ Value \times Purchase\ Frequency) \times Customer\ Lifespan$$

MQL Conversion Rate

$$\frac{Converted\ MQLs}{Total\ MQLs} \times 100$$

One-Line Summary

Marketing Research 2 focuses on measuring, analyzing, and improving marketing performance using metrics, productivity measures, mix modelling, and dashboards to support data-driven decision-making.

WEEK 8 OVERVIEW

This unit focuses on **Business-to-Business (B2B) buying behavior**, explaining how organizations make purchasing decisions, the role of the **Buying Center**, the **Industrial Buying Process Model**, and the influence of **Economic** and **Behavioral Factors** on industrial purchasing decisions.

◆ 8.1 INTRODUCTION TO INDUSTRIAL BUYING BEHAVIOR

✓ Meaning

Industrial Buying Behavior refers to the process by which organizations purchase goods, services, equipment, and raw materials required for their business operations.

Unlike consumer buying behavior, industrial buying involves:

- Multiple decision-makers
 - Larger purchase values
 - Complex evaluations
 - Long-term supplier relationships
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✓ Key Characteristics

1. Organizational Nature

- Decisions are made by organizations, not individuals.

2. Complex Purchases

- High-value and technically complex purchases.

3. Relationship-Oriented

- Focus on long-term buyer–seller relationships.

4. Multiple Decision-Makers

- Different departments participate in decision-making.
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✓ Factors Influencing Industrial Buying

Factor	Influence
Organizational Needs	Production & operational requirements

Factor	Influence
Supplier Relationships	Trust, reliability, partnership
Economic Factors	Cost, profitability, efficiency
Technological Factors	Innovation and technological changes

Types of Industrial Buying Situations

1. Straight Rebuy

- Routine purchase
- Minimal evaluation
- Existing suppliers

Example: Monthly office stationery purchase

2. Modified Rebuy

- Existing purchase with modifications

Example: Changing supplier or product specifications

3. New Task

- Completely new purchase
- Extensive evaluation required

Example: Purchasing a new ERP system

Importance

- Develop strategic partnerships
 - Design targeted B2B marketing strategies
 - Reduce purchasing risks
 - Identify market opportunities
-

8.2 CONCEPT OF BUYING CENTER

✓ Meaning

A **Buying Center** is the group of people within an organization who participate in or influence purchasing decisions.

✓ Characteristics

Cross-Functional Nature

Includes members from:

- Finance
- Production
- Marketing
- Procurement
- Operations

Collective Decision Making

Purchasing decisions are made jointly.

Role-Based Participation

Each member performs a specific role.

✓ Roles in a Buying Center (Very Important)

Role	Responsibility
Initiator	Recognizes need
Gatekeeper	Controls information flow
Influencer	Provides advice and expertise
Buyer	Negotiates and purchases
Decider	Makes final decision
User	Uses the product/service

✓ Factors Affecting Buying Center Dynamics

- Purchase complexity
 - Organizational structure
 - Product importance
 - Supplier relationships
-

✓ Importance of Understanding Buying Centers

- Better targeting of decision-makers
 - Effective communication
 - Stronger supplier relationships
 - Greater influence on purchasing decisions
-

◆ 8.3 INDUSTRIAL BUYING PROCESS MODEL

✓ Meaning

The Industrial Buying Process Model explains the stages organizations follow while purchasing industrial products and services.

✓ Stages of Industrial Buying Process

1. Recognition of Need

- Organization identifies a problem or requirement.
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2. Identification of Problem/Need

- Detailed analysis of the requirement.
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3. Establishment of Decision Criteria

- Define specifications and objectives.
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4. Search for Potential Suppliers

- Identify possible vendors.
-

5. Evaluation of Alternatives

- Compare suppliers based on:
 - Quality
 - Price
 - Features
 - Reputation
-

6. Selection of Supplier

- Choose the most suitable supplier.
 - Negotiate terms and conditions.
-

7. Order Processing & Implementation

- Finalize contracts and place orders.
-

8. Post-Purchase Evaluation

- Assess:
 - Supplier performance
 - Product quality
 - Customer satisfaction
-

Factors Affecting the Process

1. Organizational Structure
 2. Buying Center Dynamics
 3. Product Complexity
 4. Supplier Relationships
-

Quick Flow

Need Recognition → Problem Analysis → Decision Criteria → Supplier Search → Evaluation → Supplier Selection → Order Processing → Post-Purchase Evaluation

◆ 8.4 INFLUENCE OF ECONOMIC FACTORS

Economic factors strongly affect industrial purchasing decisions.

✓ Major Economic Influences

1. Macroeconomic Conditions

Economic Cycles

- Recession → Reduced spending
- Boom → Increased investments

Interest Rates

- Higher rates → Lower capital purchases
 - Lower rates → Higher investments
-

2. Cost Considerations

Price Sensitivity

Organizations seek maximum value.

Budget Constraints

Limited budgets delay purchases.

3. Supply Chain & Globalization

Global Market Conditions

Affect availability and pricing.

Exchange Rates

Influence import costs.

4. Technological Investments

Economic growth encourages:

- Innovation
- Automation

- Advanced technology purchases
-

5. Government Policies

Includes:

- Tax policies
 - Subsidies
 - Trade regulations
 - Tariffs
-

6. Consumer Demand

Higher consumer demand leads to:

- Increased industrial production
 - Increased industrial purchases
-

Key Takeaway

Economic conditions directly influence purchasing power, investment decisions, and procurement strategies.

◆ 8.5 INFLUENCE OF BEHAVIORAL FACTORS

Behavioral factors focus on psychological and social influences affecting industrial buying decisions.

Major Behavioral Influences

1. Organizational Culture & Structure

- Centralized vs decentralized decisions
 - Organizational values influence buying choices
-

2. Perceived Risk & Uncertainty

Risk Aversion

Organizations avoid risky purchases.

Information Asymmetry

Lack of information increases uncertainty.

3. Vendor Credibility & Relationships

Trust and Reputation

Reliable suppliers gain preference.

Long-Term Relationships

Influence repeat purchases.

4. Individual & Group Influences

Personal Preferences

Decision-makers may favor certain brands.

Group Dynamics

Consensus-building affects decisions.

5. Perception & Attitudes

Perceived Value

Assessment based on:

- Quality
- Benefits
- Reliability

Attitude Toward Change

Resistance to change may delay adoption.

6. Psychological Factors

Motivation & Incentives

Performance incentives influence decisions.

Perception of Needs

Organizational priorities determine purchases.

 Key Takeaway

Industrial buying decisions are influenced not only by economics but also by trust, perceptions, organizational culture, and human behavior.

 EXPECTED EXAM QUESTIONS WITH SHORT ANSWERS

Q1. Define Industrial Buying Behavior.

Answer: Industrial buying behavior is the process through which organizations purchase goods and services required for business operations.

Q2. Explain the types of industrial buying situations.

Answer:

- Straight Rebuy
 - Modified Rebuy
 - New Task
-

Q3. What is a Buying Center?

Answer: A buying center is a group of individuals within an organization who participate in or influence purchasing decisions.

Q4. Explain the roles in a Buying Center.

Answer: Initiator, Gatekeeper, Influencer, Buyer, Decider, and User.

Q5. Explain the Industrial Buying Process Model.

Answer: It consists of:

Need Recognition → Problem Identification → Decision Criteria → Supplier Search → Evaluation → Selection → Order Processing → Post-Purchase Evaluation.

Q6. Discuss the influence of economic factors on industrial buying.

Answer: Economic cycles, interest rates, pricing, budgets, globalization, exchange rates, and government policies significantly affect industrial purchasing decisions.

Q7. Explain behavioral factors influencing industrial buying.

Answer: Organizational culture, risk perception, supplier trust, group dynamics, attitudes, and psychological motivations influence buying decisions.

 CASE STUDY–BASED ANSWERS (MARKETING MANAGEMENT)

Case 1: Manufacturing Company Selecting a New Machinery Supplier

Analysis

- New Task purchase
- Multiple departments involved
- High financial risk

Solution

- Form buying center
 - Evaluate suppliers
 - Compare cost, quality, and support
 - Conduct post-purchase review
-

Case 2: Organization Continues Buying from Expensive Supplier

Analysis

Behavioral factors dominate:

- Trust
- Reputation
- Long-term relationship

Solution

Supplier should emphasize:

- Reliability
- Service quality

- Relationship management
-

Case 3: Economic Recession Reduces Industrial Purchases

Analysis

Economic factors:

- Budget constraints
- Price sensitivity
- Reduced investments

Solution

Suppliers should:

- Offer discounts
 - Flexible payment terms
 - Value-based pricing
-

Case 4: Conflict Among Buying Center Members

Analysis

Different stakeholders have different objectives:

- Finance → Cost
- Production → Quality
- Operations → Performance

Solution

Provide customized information to each stakeholder and build consensus.

FINAL EXAM REVISION SHEET

Industrial Buying Behavior

→ Organizational purchasing process

Types of Buying Situations

→ Straight Rebuy → Modified Rebuy → New Task

Buying Center Roles

→ Initiator, Gatekeeper, Influencer, Buyer, Decider, User

Industrial Buying Process

→ Need → Criteria → Supplier Search → Evaluation → Selection → Purchase → Review

Economic Factors

→ Interest Rates, Budget, Pricing, Exchange Rates, Government Policies

Behavioral Factors

→ Trust, Culture, Risk Perception, Attitudes, Group Dynamics

One-Line Summary

Industrial buying behavior is a complex B2B decision-making process involving multiple stakeholders, economic considerations, behavioral influences, and systematic evaluation of suppliers to achieve organizational objectives.

WEEK 9 OVERVIEW

This unit focuses on:

- Influence of Procurement Organization
- Role of Negotiation Process
- Global Marketing
- Emerging Marketing Trends
- Industrial Buyer Behavior Case Study

The central theme is understanding how procurement structures, negotiations, globalization, and modern marketing trends influence industrial buying decisions and business success.

◆ 9.1 INFLUENCE OF PROCUREMENT ORGANIZATION

✓ Meaning

The **Procurement Organization** is responsible for purchasing goods and services required by a business. Its structure, objectives, and strategies significantly influence buying decisions.

✓ Key Influences on Purchasing Decisions

1. Decision-Making Structure

Centralized Procurement

- Purchasing authority is concentrated.
- Better negotiation power.
- Cost control and standardization.

Decentralized Procurement

- Departments make independent decisions.
 - Greater flexibility.
 - Higher risk of cost variation.
-

2. Strategic Alignment

Procurement objectives should align with organizational goals.

Example: If the company aims to reduce costs, procurement focuses on negotiating better prices.

3. Supplier Relationship Management

Strong supplier relationships provide:

- Better service
- Favorable terms
- Long-term partnerships
- Innovation opportunities

4. Risk Management

Procurement manages:

- Supply continuity
- Quality assurance
- Compliance
- Operational risks

5. Technology & Innovation

Modern procurement uses:

- E-procurement systems
- Analytics tools
- E-sourcing platforms

to improve efficiency and decision-making.

6. Cost Control & Savings

Focuses on:

- Better pricing
- Volume discounts
- Cost-efficient alternatives

without compromising quality.

7. Compliance & Ethics

Ensures:

- Legal compliance
 - Ethical sourcing
 - Sustainability practices
-

8. Supply Chain Resilience

Builds resilience through:

- Supplier diversification
 - Alternate sourcing
 - Crisis management
-

Key Takeaway

Procurement influences cost, quality, supplier relationships, risk management, and overall business performance.

◆ 9.2 ROLE OF NEGOTIATION PROCESS

✓ Meaning

Negotiation is the process through which buyers and sellers discuss and agree upon:

- Price
- Terms & conditions
- Delivery schedules
- Service commitments

to achieve mutually beneficial outcomes.

✓ Roles of Negotiation in Procurement

1. Cost Savings & Value Creation

Price Negotiation

Reduces procurement costs.

Value-Based Negotiation

Creates additional value through:

- Better services
 - Longer partnerships
 - Additional benefits
-

2. Supplier Relationship Building

Negotiation helps:

- Build trust
 - Improve collaboration
 - Develop strategic partnerships
-

3. Terms & Conditions Agreement

Negotiations clarify:

- Payment terms
 - Delivery schedules
 - Warranty conditions
 - Service-level agreements (SLAs)
-

4. Risk Mitigation & Compliance

Negotiations help:

- Identify risks
 - Develop contingency plans
 - Ensure legal compliance
 - Promote ethical practices
-

5. Innovation & Quality Improvement

Encourages suppliers to:

- Offer innovative solutions

- Improve product quality
 - Invest in R&D
-

6. Conflict Resolution

Provides a structured mechanism to:

- Resolve disputes
 - Improve communication
 - Maintain relationships
-

Key Takeaway

Effective negotiation creates value, reduces costs, minimizes risks, and strengthens buyer-supplier relationships.

◆ 9.3 GLOBAL MARKETING

✅ Meaning

Global Marketing refers to planning, producing, promoting, and distributing products/services across international markets.

✅ Key Elements of Global Marketing

1. Market Expansion

- Enter international markets.
 - Reach new customer segments.
-

2. Cultural Sensitivity & Adaptation

Cultural Awareness

Understand:

- Language
- Traditions
- Values

- Consumer behavior

Localization

Adapt products and marketing messages to local markets.

3. Global Branding & Positioning

Brand Consistency

Maintain a consistent global image.

Positioning Strategy

Position products effectively in different regions.

4. Market Research & Analysis

Understand:

- Consumer preferences
- Competitors
- Market trends

before entering foreign markets.

5. Distribution & Channel Management

Includes:

- Global supply chain management
 - Local partnerships
 - Distribution networks
-

6. Legal & Regulatory Compliance

Must comply with:

- International trade laws
- Tariffs
- Regulations
- Ethical standards

7. Digital Marketing & Technology

Uses:

- Social media
- Website localization
- Online advertising
- E-commerce

for global reach.

8. Global Marketing Strategies

Strategy	Meaning
Standardization	Same strategy globally
Adaptation	Customized locally
Glocalization	Global consistency + Local adaptation

Challenges in Global Marketing

- Cultural differences
 - Logistics complexity
 - Legal barriers
 - Global competition
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Key Takeaway

Successful global marketing requires balancing standardization with local adaptation (Glocalization).

◆ 9.4 TRENDS IN MARKETING

Major Emerging Trends

1. Digital Transformation

- Online marketing
 - Data-driven decisions
 - Omnichannel engagement
-

2. Personalization & Customer-Centricity

Using customer data to deliver:

- Customized offers
 - Personalized experiences
-

3. Content Marketing & Storytelling

Building engagement through:

- Valuable content
 - Brand stories
 - Emotional connections
-

4. Artificial Intelligence (AI) & Automation

Applications:

- Predictive analytics
 - Chatbots
 - Marketing automation
-

5. Influencer Marketing

Collaboration with:

- Influencers
- Micro-influencers

to promote products.

6. Sustainability & Ethical Branding

Growing focus on:

- Eco-friendly products
 - CSR activities
 - Ethical business practices
-

7. Voice Search & Smart Assistants

Optimizing content for:

- Voice search
 - Smart devices
-

8. Augmented Reality (AR) & Virtual Reality (VR)

Used for:

- Product demonstrations
 - Interactive experiences
 - Virtual trials
-

9. Video Marketing Dominance

Popular formats:

- Short-form videos
 - Live streaming
 - Video storytelling
-

10. Subscription-Based Models

Examples:

- Netflix
- Spotify
- SaaS platforms

Benefits:

- Recurring revenue
- Long-term customer relationships

Key Takeaway

Modern marketing is increasingly digital, personalized, automated, and experience-driven.

◆ 9.5 CASE STUDY: ABC MACHINERY

Background

ABC Machinery manufactured advanced agricultural machinery but struggled to penetrate new markets.

Research Conducted

Methods Used

- Surveys
 - Interviews
 - Competitor analysis
 - CRM analysis
 - Sales data analysis
-

Key Findings

1. Reliability Matters More Than Features

Buyers prioritized:

- Durability
- Consistent performance

over advanced technology.

2. Word-of-Mouth Influence

Recommendations from:

- Farmers
- Industry experts

strongly affected purchasing decisions.

3. Importance of Long-Term Relationships

Buyers preferred manufacturers providing:

- After-sales support
- Maintenance services
- Spare parts availability

Action Plan

Focused Messaging

Highlighted:

- Reliability
- Durability

instead of technical features.

Customer Education

Used:

- Testimonials
- Case studies

to build trust.

Improved After-Sales Service

Provided:

- Extended warranties
- Maintenance support
- Spare parts availability

Outcome

- Increased market share
- Higher customer satisfaction
- Stronger brand loyalty
- More referrals

Lesson Learned

Understanding industrial buyer behavior enables firms to align products, communication, and services with customer priorities, leading to better market performance.

EXPECTED EXAM QUESTIONS WITH ANSWERS

Q1. Explain the influence of procurement organization on purchasing decisions. (10 Marks)

Answer: Procurement influences decision-making through centralized/decentralized structures, supplier relationship management, cost control, risk management, technology adoption, compliance, and supply chain resilience.

Q2. Explain the role of negotiation in procurement. (10 Marks)

Answer: Negotiation helps achieve cost savings, create value, build supplier relationships, manage risks, improve quality, encourage innovation, and resolve conflicts.

Q3. What is Global Marketing? Explain its key elements. (10 Marks)

Answer: Global marketing is the process of marketing products internationally. Key elements include market expansion, cultural adaptation, branding, research, distribution, compliance, digital marketing, and glocalization.

Q4. Discuss emerging trends in marketing. (10 Marks)

Answer: Key trends include digital transformation, personalization, AI, influencer marketing, sustainability, voice search, AR/VR, video marketing, and subscription models.

Q5. Explain the concept of Glocalization. (5 Marks)

Answer: Glocalization refers to maintaining a global brand identity while adapting products and marketing strategies to local market requirements.

CASE STUDY-BASED ANSWERS (MARKETING MANAGEMENT)

Case 1: Company Expanding Internationally

Issue: Difficulty entering foreign markets.

Solution:

- Conduct market research.
 - Adapt marketing messages.
 - Follow localization strategy.
 - Build local partnerships.
-

Case 2: Supplier Price Dispute

Issue: Rising procurement costs.

Solution:

- Use negotiation strategies.
 - Focus on value-based agreements.
 - Develop long-term supplier relationships.
-

Case 3: Supply Chain Disruption

Issue: Supplier failure affects production.

Solution:

- Diversify suppliers.
 - Build procurement resilience.
 - Develop contingency plans.
-

Case 4: Marketing Campaign Not Engaging Customers

Issue: Low customer engagement.

Solution:

- Use personalized marketing.
 - Implement content marketing.
 - Leverage influencers and video marketing.
-

 **FINAL QUICK REVISION**

Procurement Organization

→ Cost control, supplier management, risk management

Negotiation

→ Cost savings + Value creation + Relationship building

Global Marketing

→ Standardization + Adaptation + Glocalization

Marketing Trends

→ AI, Personalization, Influencers, Sustainability, AR/VR

ABC Machinery Lesson

→ Reliability + Trust + After-sales service drive industrial buying decisions

One-Line Summary

Week 9 highlights how procurement, negotiation, globalization, and emerging marketing trends influence organizational buying decisions and business success in modern markets.

WEEK 10 OVERVIEW

This unit focuses on:

- Introduction to Online Marketing
- Advantages & Disadvantages of Online Marketing
- Communication Forms and Types
- Advantages & Disadvantages of Communication

The central theme is understanding how businesses use digital channels to communicate, engage customers, build relationships, and achieve marketing objectives.

◆ 10.1 INTRODUCTION TO ONLINE MARKETING

✔ Meaning

Online Marketing (Digital Marketing) refers to the use of internet-based platforms and digital technologies to promote products, services, or brands and engage target customers.

Objectives:

- Reach target audiences
 - Generate traffic
 - Create engagement
 - Convert leads into customers
-

✔ Key Components of Online Marketing

Component	Purpose
Website Optimization	Improve user experience and navigation
SEO (Search Engine Optimization)	Improve search rankings
Content Marketing	Attract and retain customers through valuable content
Social Media Marketing	Build awareness and engagement
Email Marketing	Nurture leads and customer relationships
PPC Advertising	Generate immediate traffic through paid ads

Component	Purpose
Online Advertising	Reach wider audiences through digital ads
Influencer Marketing	Leverage influencers for promotion
Affiliate Marketing	Earn sales through affiliate partners
Analytics & Data Analysis	Measure and optimize performance

✅ Importance of Online Marketing

1. Global Reach

Reach customers beyond geographical boundaries.

2. Targeted Marketing

Target specific demographics, interests, and behaviors.

3. Cost Effectiveness

Lower cost compared to traditional marketing.

4. Measurable Results

Track and analyze campaign performance in real time.

🎯 Key Takeaway

Online Marketing = Global Reach + Targeted Communication + Measurable Results

◆ 10.2 ADVANTAGES OF ONLINE MARKETING

✅ Major Advantages

1. Global Reach

Access customers worldwide.

2. Targeted Advertising

Reach the right audience based on:

- Age
- Interests

- Location
- Behavior

3. Cost Effectiveness

Higher ROI compared to traditional media.

4. Measurable Results

Track:

- Website traffic
- Conversions
- Click-through rates (CTR)
- Engagement levels

5. Interactivity & Engagement

Allows direct customer interaction through:

- Social media
- Reviews
- Live chats

6. Flexibility & Adaptability

Campaigns can be modified instantly.

7. 24/7 Availability

Customers can interact anytime.

8. Enhanced Customer Insights

Collect valuable customer data and preferences.

9. Multiple Channels & Formats

Use:

- Social media
- Email
- Blogs
- Videos
- Websites

10. Technology Integration

Leverages:

- AI
 - Machine Learning
 - Chatbots
 - Automation
-

Exam Tip

The most commonly asked advantages:

Global Reach, Targeted Marketing, Cost Effectiveness, Measurability, Customer Engagement.

◆ 10.3 DISADVANTAGES OF ONLINE MARKETING

✓ Major Disadvantages

1. High Competition

Difficult to stand out in crowded digital markets.

2. Technical Issues

Website crashes, server failures, connectivity problems.

3. Security Concerns

Data privacy and cyber-security risks.

4. Technology Dependence

Businesses rely heavily on digital platforms.

5. Information Overload

Consumers are exposed to excessive content.

6. Negative Feedback Amplification

Negative reviews spread quickly online.

7. Skill & Resource Requirements

Requires expertise in:

- SEO
- Social media
- Analytics

- Content creation

8. Ad Blocking

Users may block advertisements.

9. Measurement Challenges

Data interpretation can be complex.

10. Lack of Personal Touch

Less human interaction compared to traditional channels.

Key Takeaway

While online marketing offers tremendous opportunities, businesses must address competition, technology dependence, and security concerns.

◆ 10.4 COMMUNICATION FORMS AND TYPES

Communication is essential for engaging, informing, persuading, and maintaining relationships with customers.

Communication Forms

1. Written Communication

Examples:

- Emails
- Blog posts
- Articles
- Social media posts
- eBooks
- Whitepapers

Purpose: Inform, educate, and persuade.

2. Visual Communication

Examples:

- Images
- Infographics
- Videos
- Presentations
- GIFs
- Visual advertisements

Purpose: Attract attention and improve engagement.

3. Interactive Communication

Examples:

- Webinars
- Live videos
- Quizzes
- Polls
- Surveys

Purpose: Encourage audience participation.

4. Audio Communication

Examples:

- Podcasts
- Audio advertisements
- Voice assistants (Alexa, Siri)

Purpose: Convenient content consumption.

✓ Communication Types by Purpose

Type	Purpose	Examples
Informational	Educate audience	Tutorials, guides
Promotional	Promote offerings	Ads, discounts

Type	Purpose	Examples
Engagement-Oriented	Encourage interaction	Quizzes, contests
Transactional	Facilitate sales	Receipts, confirmations
Relationship-Building	Maintain relationships	Newsletters, follow-ups

Communication Types by Channel

Social Media Communication

- Posts
- Stories
- Live sessions
- Direct messages

Email Communication

- Newsletters
- Promotional emails
- Transactional emails

Website Communication

- Blogs
- Landing pages
- Chatbots

Advertising Communication

- Banner ads
- Search ads
- Sponsored content
- Video ads

Key Takeaway

An effective digital marketing strategy uses multiple communication forms, purposes, and channels to maximize engagement and conversions.

◆ 10.5 ADVANTAGES & DISADVANTAGES OF COMMUNICATION

✓ Advantages of Effective Communication

1. Clarity & Understanding

Reduces misunderstandings.

2. Improved Relationships

Builds trust and collaboration.

3. Increased Productivity

Improves efficiency and coordination.

4. Informed Decision-Making

Provides accurate information for decisions.

5. Conflict Resolution

Facilitates problem-solving and consensus.

6. Enhanced Innovation

Encourages idea sharing and creativity.

✓ Disadvantages of Ineffective Communication

1. Misunderstandings & Confusion

Leads to mistakes and poor decisions.

2. Strained Relationships

Creates distrust and conflicts.

3. Reduced Productivity

Causes delays and inefficiencies.

4. Missed Opportunities

Business opportunities may be lost.

5. Rumors & Gossip

Promotes misinformation.

6. Resistance to Change

Employees may oppose organizational changes.

Key Takeaway

Effective communication promotes understanding, productivity, innovation, and strong relationships, whereas ineffective communication creates confusion, conflict, and inefficiency.

EXPECTED EXAM QUESTIONS WITH ANSWERS

Q1. Define Online Marketing and explain its components. (10 Marks)

Answer:

Online marketing is the use of internet-based channels to promote products and services. Key components include SEO, content marketing, social media marketing, email marketing, PPC, online advertising, influencer marketing, affiliate marketing, and analytics.

Q2. Explain the advantages and disadvantages of Online Marketing. (10 Marks)

Advantages:

- Global reach
- Targeted advertising
- Cost effectiveness
- Measurable results
- Customer engagement

Disadvantages:

- High competition
 - Security concerns
 - Technical issues
 - Ad blocking
 - Lack of personal touch
-

Q3. Discuss communication forms used in digital marketing. (10 Marks)

Answer:

Communication forms include:

- Written communication
- Visual communication
- Interactive communication
- Audio communication

Each serves different customer engagement purposes.

Q4. Explain communication types based on purpose. (10 Marks)**Answer:**

- Informational
- Promotional
- Engagement-oriented
- Transactional
- Relationship-building

These help marketers achieve different communication objectives.

Q5. Explain the advantages and disadvantages of effective communication. (5 Marks)**Answer:**

Advantages include clarity, productivity, better relationships, innovation, and conflict resolution. Disadvantages of poor communication include misunderstandings, reduced productivity, strained relationships, and missed opportunities.

 CASE STUDY–BASED ANSWERS (MARKETING MANAGEMENT)**Case 1: Low Website Traffic****Problem**

Company website receives very few visitors.

Solution

- Improve SEO
- Use PPC advertising

- Increase content marketing efforts
 - Utilize social media campaigns
-

Case 2: Negative Brand Reviews Going Viral

Problem

Negative customer feedback spreads rapidly online.

Solution

- Respond quickly
 - Address customer concerns transparently
 - Strengthen customer support
 - Monitor social media sentiment
-

Case 3: Low Customer Engagement on Social Media

Problem

Customers are not interacting with content.

Solution

- Use interactive communication
 - Conduct polls and contests
 - Share engaging videos and infographics
 - Collaborate with influencers
-

Case 4: Poor Internal Communication in Marketing Team

Problem

Campaign delays and confusion.

Solution

- Establish clear communication channels
- Use regular updates and meetings
- Improve documentation
- Encourage feedback sharing

FINAL QUICK REVISION

Online Marketing Components

→ SEO, Content Marketing, Social Media, Email, PPC, Influencer Marketing, Analytics

Major Advantages

→ Global Reach, Targeted Marketing, Cost Effectiveness, Measurability

Major Disadvantages

→ Competition, Security Risks, Technical Issues, Information Overload

Communication Forms

→ Written, Visual, Interactive, Audio

Communication Types

→ Informational, Promotional, Engagement-Oriented, Transactional, Relationship-Building

One-Line Summary

Week 10 focuses on how businesses use online marketing and digital communication channels to engage customers, build relationships, improve marketing effectiveness, and achieve business goals in the digital era.

WEEK 11 OVERVIEW

This unit focuses on:

- Social Media Marketing (SMM)
- Major Social Media Platforms
- Word of Mouth (WoM) Marketing
- Creating Word-of-Mouth Buzz
- Digital Communication Case Study

The core theme is how businesses use social media and customer recommendations to build brand awareness, customer engagement, trust, and sales.

◆ 11.1 SOCIAL MEDIA MARKETING (SMM)

✓ Meaning

Social Media Marketing (SMM) is the use of social media platforms to promote products, services, or brands and engage with customers.

Objectives:

- Increase brand awareness
 - Drive website traffic
 - Generate leads and sales
 - Build customer relationships
-

✓ Key Components of SMM

Component	Purpose
Content Creation & Sharing	Posts, images, videos, stories
Audience Engagement	Responding to comments/messages
Social Advertising	Paid ads targeting specific audiences
Influencer Partnerships	Expanding reach and credibility
Analytics & Monitoring	Measuring campaign performance

✅ Advantages of Social Media Marketing

1. Wider Reach

Access to global audiences.

2. Engagement & Interaction

Direct communication with customers.

3. Cost-Effective

Lower cost than traditional advertising.

4. Brand Visibility

Increases awareness through shares, likes, and mentions.

5. Targeted Advertising

Precise audience targeting based on demographics and behavior.

✅ Challenges of SMM

- Constant platform changes
 - Negative feedback and viral backlash
 - Time-consuming content management
 - Difficulty measuring ROI
 - Algorithm changes affecting reach
-

🎯 Key Takeaway

Social Media Marketing = Content + Engagement + Advertising + Analytics

◆ 11.2 SOCIAL MEDIA PLATFORMS

✅ Major Platforms and Their Uses

Platform	Key Features	Best For
Facebook	Pages, Groups, Ads, Live Video	Broad audience targeting
Instagram	Photos, Stories, Reels, Shopping	Visual branding

Platform	Key Features	Best For
Twitter (X)	Tweets, Trends, Hashtags	Real-time communication
LinkedIn	Professional networking	B2B marketing
YouTube	Video content	Tutorials & storytelling
TikTok	Short-form videos	Youth-focused campaigns
Pinterest	Pins & Boards	Fashion, décor, lifestyle
Snapchat	Stories, AR filters	Young audiences
Reddit	Communities & discussions	Niche engagement
WhatsApp	Messaging & Business Accounts	Customer support

Exam Tip

Platform for B2B Marketing:

→ LinkedIn

Platform for Video Marketing:

→ YouTube

Platform for Youth-Oriented Marketing:

→ TikTok / Snapchat

◆ 11.3 WORD OF MOUTH (WoM) MARKETING

✓ Meaning

Word of Mouth (WoM) refers to informal communication between people regarding products, services, or brands based on personal experiences.

It is one of the most trusted forms of marketing.

✓ Characteristics of WoM

1. Informal Communication

Occurs naturally through conversations.

2. Trust & Credibility

Recommendations come from trusted sources.

3. Social Media Amplification

Online sharing increases reach.

4. Direct Influence

Strongly affects buying decisions.

5. Two Forms

Type	Meaning
Organic WoM	Happens naturally
Amplified WoM	Encouraged by companies

✅ Factors Influencing WoM

Product Quality & Experience

Good experiences generate recommendations.

Customer Service

Excellent service encourages sharing.

Innovation & Uniqueness

Unique products create buzz.

Incentives & Rewards

Referral programs stimulate recommendations.

Emotional Impact

Strong emotions increase sharing behavior.

✅ Importance of WoM

Trust & Credibility

More trusted than traditional advertising.

Cost Effective

Relies on satisfied customers.

Customer Engagement

Promotes interaction and discussion.

Digital Amplification

Social media spreads recommendations rapidly.

Key Takeaway

Word of Mouth = Trust + Experience + Recommendation

◆ 11.4 CREATING WORD-OF-MOUTH BUZZ

Strategies to Generate WoM

1. Exceptional Product or Service

Deliver quality beyond expectations.

2. Identify Brand Advocates

Encourage loyal customers to promote the brand.

3. Create Shareable Content

Use:

- Videos
 - Blogs
 - Infographics
 - Stories
-

4. Leverage Social Media

Encourage:

- User-generated content
 - Contests
 - Challenges
 - Discussions
-

5. Influencer Marketing

Partner with influencers whose values align with the brand.

6. Referral Programs

Offer:

- Discounts
- Rewards
- Exclusive benefits

for successful referrals.

7. Exceptional Customer Service

Resolve issues quickly and exceed expectations.

8. Reviews & Testimonials

Encourage customers to share positive experiences.

9. Community Building

Create:

- Forums
 - Events
 - Webinars
 - Brand communities
-

10. Monitor & Respond

Respond promptly to:

- Positive feedback
 - Complaints
 - Online conversations
-

Key Takeaway

WoM Buzz is created through exceptional experiences, customer advocacy, social sharing, and relationship building.

◆ 11.5 CASE STUDY: XYZ FASHION HOUSE

✓ Background

XYZ Fashion House wanted to improve:

- Online visibility
- Social media engagement
- Mobile marketing effectiveness

amid increasing competition.

✓ Challenges

1. Limited Online Presence

Low visibility among digital consumers.

2. Poor Social Media Engagement

Low audience interaction.

3. Lack of Mobile Optimization

Poor mobile user experience.

✓ Strategies Implemented

Enhanced Online Presence

- Website redesign
- SEO implementation

Revamped Social Media

- Audience analysis
- Interactive content
- Influencer collaborations

Mobile-Centric Approach

- Dedicated mobile app
 - Personalized recommendations
 - Mobile-friendly campaigns
-

Results

Website Performance

- 40% increase in traffic
- 25% increase in conversions

Social Media

- 50% increase in engagement

Mobile App

- 100,000 downloads in 3 months
 - 30% increase in mobile sales
-

Lesson Learned

Integrated digital communication (website + social media + mobile marketing) significantly improves engagement, visibility, and sales.

EXPECTED EXAM QUESTIONS WITH ANSWERS

Q1. Define Social Media Marketing and explain its components. (10 Marks)

Answer:

Social Media Marketing is the use of social platforms to promote brands and engage customers. Components include content creation, audience engagement, social advertising, influencer partnerships, and analytics.

Q2. Explain the advantages and challenges of Social Media Marketing. (10 Marks)

Advantages: Wider reach, engagement, cost-effectiveness, visibility, targeted advertising.

Challenges: Algorithm changes, ROI measurement, negative feedback, time requirements, platform changes.

Q3. Discuss the major social media platforms used in marketing. (10 Marks)

Answer: Facebook, Instagram, Twitter (X), LinkedIn, YouTube, TikTok, Pinterest, Snapchat, Reddit, and WhatsApp, each serving different audience and marketing objectives.

Q4. What is Word of Mouth Marketing? Explain its importance. (10 Marks)

Answer: WoM is informal communication about products/services among consumers. It builds trust, influences purchasing decisions, and offers cost-effective promotion.

Q5. Explain strategies for creating Word-of-Mouth Buzz. (10 Marks)

Answer: Provide excellent products, identify brand advocates, create shareable content, leverage social media, use influencers, offer referrals, encourage reviews, and build communities.

 CASE STUDY–BASED ANSWERS (MARKETING MANAGEMENT)

Case 1: Brand Facing Low Social Media Engagement

Problem

Low likes, shares, and comments.

Solution

- Improve content quality
 - Use videos and reels
 - Conduct contests and polls
 - Collaborate with influencers
-

Case 2: New Product Not Generating Buzz

Problem

Low awareness and customer discussion.

Solution

- Create shareable content
 - Launch referral programs
 - Encourage reviews
 - Use brand advocates
-

Case 3: Negative Reviews Affecting Reputation

Problem

Customer complaints spreading online.

Solution

- Respond promptly
- Improve customer service
- Resolve issues publicly
- Monitor social media sentiment

Case 4: Fashion Brand Seeking Digital Growth

Solution (XYZ Fashion House Model)

- Strengthen website and SEO
- Improve social media engagement
- Adopt mobile-first marketing
- Use personalized communication

FINAL QUICK REVISION

Social Media Marketing Components

→ Content • Engagement • Advertising • Influencers • Analytics

Top Platforms

→ Facebook • Instagram • LinkedIn • YouTube • TikTok • WhatsApp

Word of Mouth (WoM)

→ Informal recommendations based on trust and experience

Types of WoM

→ Organic WoM • Amplified WoM

Creating WoM Buzz

→ Quality • Advocates • Social Media • Influencers • Referrals • Reviews

XYZ Fashion House Results

- +40% Website Traffic
 - +25% Conversions
 - +50% Social Engagement
 - +30% Mobile Sales
-

One-Line Summary

Week 11 explains how social media marketing and word-of-mouth communication help businesses build trust, engage customers, enhance brand visibility, and drive sales through digital and social platforms.

WEEK 12 OVERVIEW

This unit focuses on:

- Introduction to Mobile Marketing
- Scope of Mobile Marketing
- Developing Effective Mobile Marketing Programs
- Mobile Marketing Across Markets
- Mobile Marketing Case Study

The central theme is how businesses use mobile devices, apps, SMS, location-based services, and emerging technologies to engage customers anytime and anywhere.

◆ 12.1 INTRODUCTION TO MOBILE MARKETING

✓ Meaning

Mobile Marketing refers to marketing activities specifically designed and optimized for mobile devices such as smartphones and tablets.

Why Mobile Marketing is Important?

- Smartphones are the primary internet access device for many users.
 - Mobile devices are widely used for:
 - Shopping
 - Browsing
 - Social networking
 - Entertainment
-

✓ Key Components of Mobile Marketing

Component	Purpose
Mobile-Friendly Websites	Responsive browsing experience
Mobile Apps	Customer engagement and services
SMS Marketing	Promotions and updates
Mobile Advertising	Ads on apps and mobile websites

Component	Purpose
Location-Based Marketing	Geo-targeted offers
Mobile Wallet Marketing	Loyalty programs and payments

✓ Benefits of Mobile Marketing

- Wider Reach
- Personalization
- Instant Connectivity
- Higher Engagement
- Rich Analytics & Data

✓ Challenges

- Device fragmentation (different screen sizes & OS)
- Privacy concerns
- Ad-blocking software

✓ Future Trends

- Augmented Reality (AR)
- Virtual Reality (VR)
- 5G Technology
- Voice Search
- Artificial Intelligence (AI)

Key Takeaway

Mobile Marketing = Personalized + Location-Based + Instant Customer Engagement

◆ 12.2 THE SCOPE OF MOBILE MARKETING

✓ 1. Consumer Reach

Global Penetration

Mobile devices reach almost every demographic.

24/7 Connectivity

Brands can communicate with customers anytime and anywhere.

2. Diverse Platforms & Channels

Mobile Websites

Responsive websites for seamless browsing.

Mobile Apps

Dedicated applications for engagement and transactions.

SMS/MMS

Direct communication through messages.

Social Media

Mobile-based advertising and engagement.

Mobile Advertising Networks

- In-app ads
 - Display ads
 - Native ads
 - Video ads
-

3. Targeting & Personalization

Geo-Targeting

Offers based on location.

Behavioral Targeting

Messages based on user behavior.

Contextual Targeting

Content based on current user activity.

4. E-Commerce & Mobile Payments

Mobile Shopping

Purchasing through smartphones.

Mobile Wallets

Digital payments and loyalty integration.

✅ 5. Emerging Technologies

- AR & VR
- AI & Chatbots

These improve customer experience and engagement.

✅ 6. Data Analytics & Measurement

Track:

- User engagement
 - Conversions
 - App performance
 - Customer journeys
-

Key Takeaway

Mobile Marketing combines reach, personalization, e-commerce, and analytics to create customer-centric experiences.

◆ 12.3 DEVELOPING EFFECTIVE MOBILE MARKETING PROGRAMS

✅ Steps for Effective Mobile Marketing

1. Understand Your Audience

Analyze:

- Demographics
 - Mobile usage behavior
 - Device preferences
-

2. Set Clear Objectives

Examples:

- Increase app downloads
 - Boost sales
 - Improve brand awareness
 - Drive website traffic
-

3. Create a Mobile-Friendly Experience

Responsive Design

Websites should adapt to different screen sizes.

App Optimization

Apps should be:

- Fast
 - User-friendly
 - Easy to navigate
-

4. Personalization & Targeting

Use customer data to deliver:

- Relevant content
 - Personalized offers
 - Location-specific promotions
-

5. Create Compelling Content

Characteristics:

- Short and concise
- Visually appealing
- Interactive

Examples:

- Videos

- Images
 - Interactive content
-

6. Utilize Multiple Mobile Channels

- SMS/MMS
 - Push notifications
 - Mobile apps
 - Social media
-

7. Mobile-Specific Strategies

Use:

- QR codes
 - Location-based marketing
 - Mobile payments
 - Mobile-exclusive offers
-

8. Optimize for Local Searches

Focus on:

- Local SEO
 - Nearby searches
 - Google Maps visibility
-

9. Test & Improve

Use:

- A/B Testing
 - User feedback
 - Performance metrics
-

10. Compliance & Privacy

Follow:

- GDPR
 - CCPA
 - Data protection laws
-

Key Takeaway

Successful mobile marketing requires audience understanding, personalization, optimization, testing, and compliance.

◆ 12.4 MOBILE MARKETING ACROSS MARKETS

When operating internationally, mobile marketing strategies must be adapted to local conditions.

Key Considerations

1. Market Research & Localization

Understand:

- Consumer behavior
- Mobile usage patterns
- Cultural preferences

Localization Includes:

- Language adaptation
 - Local currency
 - Cultural customization
-

2. Device & Connectivity Differences

Consider:

- Device popularity
 - Operating systems
 - Internet speeds
-

3. Adapt Marketing Strategies

Customize campaigns according to:

- Consumer habits
 - Regional trends
 - Seasonal variations
-

4. Localized Content & Messaging

Ensure:

- Cultural relevance
 - Appropriate visuals
 - Suitable symbols and references
-

5. Legal & Regulatory Compliance

Comply with:

- Privacy laws
 - Advertising regulations
 - Data protection requirements
-

6. Payment Preferences

Support:

- Local payment gateways
 - Preferred transaction methods
-

7. Local Influencers & Partnerships

Partner with:

- Regional influencers
- Local businesses

to increase trust and credibility.

8. Continuous Testing & Adaptation

Use:

- Market-specific A/B testing
 - Customer feedback
 - Performance analytics
-

9. Customer Support

Provide:

- Local language support
 - Region-specific assistance
-

Key Takeaway

Global mobile marketing succeeds through localization, cultural adaptation, compliance, and continuous optimization.

◆ 12.5 CASE STUDY – ABC FITNESS

✓ Background

ABC Fitness wanted to:

- Increase memberships
 - Improve customer engagement
 - Strengthen digital communication
-

✓ Challenges

1. Weak Online Presence

Low visibility in search results.

2. Poor Social Media Engagement

Low interaction and community participation.

3. No Mobile Strategy

Missed opportunities for member engagement.

✔ Strategies Implemented

Enhanced Online Presence

- Responsive website
- SEO and local search optimization

Improved Social Media

- Success stories
- Workout tips
- User-generated content
- Social media challenges

Mobile-Centric Approach

- Dedicated mobile app
- Push notifications
- Progress tracking
- Exclusive workouts

✔ Results

Website

- 50% increase in traffic
- 35% rise in membership inquiries
- 25% increase in new sign-ups

Social Media

- 60% growth in followers
- 40% increase in engagement

Mobile App

- 70% increase in downloads
 - 55% active engagement
 - 30% higher retention rate
-

Lesson Learned

An integrated strategy combining website optimization, social media engagement, and mobile marketing significantly improves customer acquisition, retention, and engagement.

EXPECTED EXAM QUESTIONS WITH SHORT ANSWERS

Q1. Define Mobile Marketing and explain its components. (10 Marks)

Answer: Mobile marketing is the promotion of products and services through mobile devices. Key components include mobile-friendly websites, mobile apps, SMS marketing, mobile advertising, location-based marketing, and mobile wallets.

Q2. Explain the scope of Mobile Marketing. (10 Marks)

Answer: The scope includes consumer reach, mobile websites, apps, SMS/MMS, social media, personalization, e-commerce, mobile payments, analytics, AI, AR, and VR technologies.

Q3. Discuss the steps in developing effective mobile marketing programs. (10 Marks)

Answer: Audience analysis, goal setting, mobile optimization, personalization, content creation, multi-channel marketing, local SEO, testing, and compliance.

Q4. Explain Mobile Marketing across Markets. (10 Marks)

Answer: It involves localization, cultural adaptation, legal compliance, payment customization, local partnerships, and continuous optimization for different regions.

Q5. What are the benefits and challenges of Mobile Marketing? (5 Marks)

Benefits: Wider reach, personalization, engagement, instant connectivity, analytics.

Challenges: Device fragmentation, privacy concerns, ad-blocking.

CASE STUDY-BASED ANSWERS (MARKETING MANAGEMENT)

Case 1: Mobile App Adoption is Low

Problem

Customers are not downloading the app.

Solution

- Improve app usability
 - Offer app-exclusive rewards
 - Use push notifications
 - Promote app through social media
-

Case 2: International Mobile Campaign Fails

Problem

Campaign does not resonate with foreign audiences.

Solution

- Conduct market research
 - Localize content
 - Adapt language and visuals
 - Collaborate with local influencers
-

Case 3: Poor Mobile Conversion Rates

Problem

Visitors leave before purchasing.

Solution

- Improve mobile website speed
 - Simplify checkout
 - Optimize UX/UI
 - Offer mobile payment options
-

Case 4: Fitness Brand Wants More Customer Engagement

Solution (ABC Fitness Model)

- Launch a mobile app
- Use personalized notifications
- Encourage user-generated content
- Integrate website, social media, and mobile channels

FINAL QUICK REVISION

Mobile Marketing Components

→ Mobile Websites • Apps • SMS • Mobile Ads • Geo-Targeting • Mobile Wallets

Scope of Mobile Marketing

→ Reach • Personalization • E-commerce • Analytics • AI • AR/VR

Effective Mobile Program Steps

→ Audience → Objectives → Optimization → Personalization → Testing

Global Mobile Marketing

→ Localization • Compliance • Local Influencers • Adaptation

ABC Fitness Results

- +50% Website Traffic
- +35% Membership Inquiries
- +25% Sign-Ups
- +60% Social Media Growth
- +70% App Downloads

One-Line Summary

Week 12 focuses on how businesses use mobile devices, apps, SMS, geo-targeting, personalization, and emerging technologies to engage customers, improve experiences, and drive business growth in an increasingly mobile-first world.